

## N11 RESPONSIBLE FOOD SOURCING | O (MAX : 1 PT )

**Intent :** Reduce dietary exposure to pesticides, hormones and antibiotics, limit environmental degradation and promote humane livestock practices.

**Summary :** This WELL feature requires sourcing and labeling certified organic and certified sustainable foods.

**Issue :** The use of antibiotics and hormones on animals and pesticides on produce is a global threat to public health and the ability to treat infectious diseases. Studies have confirmed that the use of antibiotics in agriculture and animals contributes to the development of antibiotic resistance in humans, and dietary pesticide exposure has been associated with adverse reproductive consequences in women and men.<sup>1-4</sup> The consumption of certain pesticides has also been linked to an increased risk for some types of cancer, and pregnant women exposed to higher amounts of pesticides have given birth to children with lower IQ.<sup>5-7</sup>

**Solutions :** Responsible sourcing practices and policies can help promote sustainable, ethical and socially responsible food purchases and promote animal welfare. While organically grown foods may not be significantly more nutritious than conventionally grown foods, organic produce has been shown to have lower levels of pesticide residue and organic chicken and pork are less likely to contain antibiotic-resistant bacteria than conventional food.<sup>8</sup> Animal welfare standards serve to ensure that animals are raised in humane conditions and address topics such as space allowance, transportation, feed and outdoor access provided for farm animals.<sup>9</sup> Humane practices also limit the use of antibiotics and hormones on animals. Labeling organic and humanely raised foods can help individuals quickly identify these products, as well as promote local farms and organizations.

### PART 1 IMPLEMENT RESPONSIBLE SOURCING (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces:*

*1: Sustainable sourcing*

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the total product line meets the following criteria:

- a. At least 50% of the total produce line (fruits and vegetables) is certified organic.<sup>10</sup>
- b. At least 25% of the total animal product line (meat, seafood, egg and dairy products) is certified organic, Certified Humane® or certified by a GSSI-recognized Seafood Certification Scheme.<sup>9,10</sup>

*2: Sustainable labeling*

Sustainable and humane agriculture is promoted through the following, as applicable:

- a.  
Certified organic and sustainable products are labeled at point-of-decision.
- b.  
Local farms or sources are advertised at point-of-decision for locally sourced foods.

### REFERENCES

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